

ZHENYU GONG

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Central University of Finance and Economics

2024 - Present

Assistant Professor, China Economics and Management Academy

EDUCATION

Brandeis University, International Business School

2018 - 2024

Ph.D. in International Economics and Finance

Renmin University of China, School of Economics

2014 - 2018

B.S. in Economics, Mathematics & Finance

RESEARCH AREAS

Economics of Innovation, Sustainable Economic Growth, Corporate Strategy, Applied Machine Learning

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Gong, Z. (Forthcoming). Heterogeneous R&D Intensity and Market Value Across Innovation Economies: Threshold Evidence from China, the U.S., and Japan. *The Journal of Technology Transfer*.
- Gong, Z., & Jefferson, G. H. (2026). [Revisiting causes and rates of patent depreciation](#). *The Journal of Technology Transfer*. Advance online publication.
- Gong, Z., & Jefferson, G. H. (2025). [Identifying technology spillovers: Evidence from firm-level patents, R&D intensity, and market value](#). *The Journal of Technology Transfer*, 50(6), 2611-2641.

Other Publications / Professional Articles

- Gong, Z. (2025). [The Effect of University Patent Transfers on Subsequent Innovation: Evidence from Chinese Universities](#). *Transfer Technológiái Bulletin*, 6(1), 29-46.
- Gong, Z., & Jefferson, G. H. (2021). [The implications of R&D intensity for innovation efficiency and firm performance: Comparing China, Japan, U.S.](#) In K. Kimura (Ed.), *Impacts of Innovation on Firm Performance and Industrial Development in East Asia* (BRC Research Report No. 29, pp. 27-55). IDE-JETRO.
- Gong, Z., & Jefferson, G. H. (2020). [The sources and impacts of firm-level innovation in China, Japan, and the U.S.](#) In K. Kimura (Ed.), *Innovation in East Asia* (BRC Research Report No. 28, pp. 1-28). IDE-JETRO.

WORKING PAPERS

Revise & Resubmit

- Gong, Z. Innovation Rhythm and Breakthrough Patenting: Evidence from U.S. Firms' Technological Portfolios. *Journal of Business Research*, Major Revision.
- Gong, Z., Tang, L., & Jefferson, G. H. [Networks and continuity of innovation: Gender disparities in patent citations](#). *Economics of Innovation and New Technology*, Major Revision.

- Gong, Z. [Forecasting Exploration–Exploitation Vacillation from Technology Portfolio Signals](#). *Journal of Modelling in Management*, Major Revision.

Work in Progress

- Gong, Z., & Jefferson, G. H. From Technology Entry to Market Innovation: The Conversion Gap. Submitted to *Production and Operations Management*
- Gong, Z. Talking Ahead or Hiding Behind? Strategic Narratives and Revealed Technological Commitment. Submitted to *Research Policy*
- Gong, Z., Li, Y.T., & Jefferson, G. H. Green Innovation Spillovers and Sustainable Firm Growth.
- Gong, Z., & Jefferson, G. H. Technological Outsiders and Recognition Barriers.

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

- **American Economic Association (AEA) Annual Meeting:** 2024
- **Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting:** 2023, 2024
- **Chinese Economists Society (CES) Annual Conference:** 2023, 2025, 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Central University of Finance and Economics	<i>2024 - Present</i>
Instructor, Corporate Finance	
Instructor, Probability and Statistics	
Brandeis University	
Instructor, Statistics for Economic Analysis	<i>2022 - 2024</i>
Instructor, Econometrics	<i>2023</i>
Instructor, Introduction to Microeconomics	<i>2021</i>

GRANTS & AWARDS

- Start-up Fund for New Faculty, Central University of Finance and Economics *2024 - 2026*
- New Seedling Scholar Research Grant, Central University of Finance and Economics *2026*
- National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC) General Program *2026*
Participant (PI: Chun Yuan)
- Alfred P. Sloan Foundation Grant *2025*
Participant; Project: "Economic Research on the Returns to R&D Investment" (PI: Gary H. Jefferson)
- IDE-JETRO Research Grant *2020 - 2022*
Participant (PI: Koichiro Kimura & Gary H. Jefferson)
- Travel Grant, American Economic Association (AEA) Annual Meeting *2024*
- Rosenberg Research Grant, Rosenberg Institute of Global Finance *2022, 2023*
- Ph.D. Fellowship, Brandeis University *2018 - 2024*

SKILLS

Programming: Stata, Python, MATLAB, L^AT_EX, R, C++

REFERENCES

Gary H. Jefferson (Chair)

Carl Marks Professor of Int. Trade and Finance
Brandeis University
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Aldo Musacchio

Professor of Business
Brandeis University
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George J. Hall

Fred C. Hecht Professor in Economics
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Richard B. Freeman

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